A better record starts here

A practical set of blank forms for documenting drainage, water conditions, construction activity and agency responses.

Start with the Event observation sheet on page 3. You do not need to use every form or understand engineering to contribute a useful record.

01 Five habits that keep the record reliable

1. **WRITE IT DOWN**
   Record the date, time, safe viewing location and what you actually saw.
2. **SAVE THE ORIGINAL**
   Keep unchanged photos, video, messages and documents in protected storage.
3. **BE SPECIFIC**
   Connect notes to a photo ID, a document number or a person who provided the information.
4. **RECORD NORMAL DAYS**
   Dry conditions, earlier drainage problems and completed repairs matter too.
5. **KEEP QUESTIONS OPEN**
   If a cause, elevation, ownership or completed repair is not verified, mark it unknown.

02 Which pages should I print?

03 Event observations
04 Photo and video index
06 Draw the water path
07 Drainage feature notes
09 Official record worksheet
10 Request and response
11 Meeting or inspection
13 Documented roles

SAFETY & PRIVACY Stay out of moving water, traffic, work zones and other property. Completed pages may contain private information; share only with permission.

SIMPLE REFERENCE IDS E-001 = event, P-001 = photograph, F-001 = feature, R-001 = record, C-001 = contact. Use one ID consistently across the pages.

Property and earlier conditions

Complete once per household, then update only when you learn something new. A memory is useful, but it is not a survey.

01 Reference details

Resident code (not full name)

Date completed / time zone

Area or property (private)

02 What you personally remember from before nearby work

Describe typical runoff, ponding, drains, storms, and how long water remained.

Approximate dates / years you directly observed

Earliest related photo or record ID

- ☐ Earlier ponding or runoff problems
- ☐ Earlier drainage worked normally
- ☐ I was not here before the work
- ☐ I cannot recall enough to compare

03 Other sources and present-day comparison

Earlier conditions reported by someone else or shown in a record (give source + date).

What looks different today? Add event or photo IDs. Record uncertainty.

Event observation record

Use one copy for each rain, dry-day or construction event. Only describe what you personally witnessed.

01 When and where

Event ID

Date + local time / time zone

Observer code

Location / safe viewpoint

Start / end time

Form completed date

02 Conditions

- [ ] Raining
- [ ] Rain recently ended
- [ ] Dry weather
- [ ] Standing water
- [ ] Water visibly flowing
- [ ] No unusual water seen

Rain timing, amount and source (if known)

Direction water moved / not clear

03 Direct observation

What did you see? Include water location, extent, timing, and any measurement + method.

04 Sources and uncertainty

Earlier conditions, other possible factors and what remains unknown.

Photo / video / record IDs

Same viewpoint as older photo? Yes / No / Unknown

Photo, video and file index

Give each file one stable ID. Do not edit the original. This is an index, not a place to attach private files.

An annotated or cropped version needs a separate ID. Record the original filename exactly. A file hash is optional and does not prove when or where an image was captured.

01 File 1 - complete all fields you know

File ID

Original filename exactly as saved

Photo / video / other

Capture date/time + time zone (or unknown)

Who made or supplied it? Private code

Location / camera direction (private)

Related event ID

Original stored at (private ref)

SHA-256 or hash record ID (optional)

Edited / share copy ID (if any)

02 File 2 - complete all fields you know

File ID

Original filename exactly as saved

Photo / video / other

Capture date/time + time zone (or unknown)

Who made or supplied it? Private code

Location / camera direction (private)

Related event ID

Original stored at (private ref)

SHA-256 or hash record ID (optional)

Edited / share copy ID (if any)

Rain and repeat observations

Compare rainfall and drainage conditions over time, including normal dry days.

Observer code

Viewpoint or area (private)

Time zone

Label each rain number as measured or reported. Include the source and period. A forecast is not an observed rainfall total.

01 Daily or storm-by-storm record

Date + local time	Rain + period + source	Water / drainage observed	Event or photo ID

02 Comparison notes

What changed across events? Note differences in storm duration, earlier problems or work completed.

Sketch the area and water path

Draw from a safe location. Mark roads, houses, swales, pipes, inlets, outlet points and camera positions. Not a survey.

Sketch / event ID

Date / time

Location / safe viewpoint

Use solid arrows for water movement you actually observed; use a question mark for a suspected or unknown connection. Do not estimate boundaries, slopes or pipe sizes by eye.

NORTH (IF KNOWN): _____

ROUGH SKETCH / NOT TO SCALE

Legend, source photo IDs, uncertain locations or other notes

Drainage feature and work notes

Use one sheet per pipe, ditch, inlet, outlet or related feature. Separate firsthand conditions from records.

Feature ID

Location / nearest landmark (private)

Date + local time

- [ ] Ditch / swale
- [ ] Pipe / culvert
- [ ] Inlet / catch basin
- [ ] Outlet / outfall
- [ ] Road / driveway
- [ ] Other / uncertain

01 Directly observed condition

Describe water, sediment, debris, damage, movement or visible work, with dates.

Event / photo IDs

Work date (if observed)

Measurement / method (or not measured)

02 What an official document states

Plan, inspection or work record: reference ID + wording and date. Proposed is not completed.

Documented owner or maintainer / source ID

Still needs verification

Before, during and after

Compare the same location and conditions over time. If a period has no firsthand evidence, mark it unknown.

Comparison ID	Viewpoint / location (private)	Prepared date

01 Before nearby work

Dates, what was present and which photos or records support it.

02 During nearby work

Dates, observations and supporting photos or records.

03 After the observed work

Dates, what changed or stayed the same and supporting references.

- ☐ Same viewpoint confirmed
- ☐ Comparable rainfall confirmed
- ☐ Earlier conditions not known
- ☐ Different conditions may explain change

Official document worksheet

Use for an obtained permit, plan, survey, inspection, correspondence or recorded instrument. Keep its original unchanged.

01 Document identity

Record ID

Exact title / document number

Document date

Agency / issuing source

Obtained on + from where

Version / page reference

02 What it actually says

Quote or summarize accurately. Include page, drawing, condition or note number.

- ☐ Proposed / recommended
- ☐ Approved / issued
- ☐ Inspection comment
- ☐ Recorded / certified
- ☐ Completion documented
- ☐ Status is unclear

03 What this record does NOT establish

Which detail remains unconfirmed? Include competing information or limitations.

Original document retained at (private reference)

Related feature / permit / event IDs

Request and response record

Use one sheet per request, inspection report or other contact. A prepared draft does not mean it was sent.

01 Who was contacted and when

Contact ID

Office / agency / role

Sent date + time zone

Method / destination (private)

Receipt, case or request number

02 Exact information requested

What existing records or actions did you ask for? Keep an unchanged copy of the outgoing message.

Status: Draft / Sent / Acknowledged / Partial / Answered

Reply date

03 What was received and what is outstanding

Write the exact response, missing items and filename or record IDs. Do not fill gaps by guessing.

Original reply + attachments saved? Yes / No / Pending

Next follow-up date / who

Meeting and inspection notes

Record direct quotations separately from paraphrases. A promise to do work is different from confirmation it was done.

Meeting / visit ID

Date, start / end + time zone

Location / format

Agency, department and roles of attendees

Note taker private code

01 Questions and answers

Question(s) asked, including the person or office who answered.

Response given. Label exact quote versus your own description.

02 Actions and follow-up

Promised record, visit or action	Contact / office	Agreed date	Proof or status ID

Case / inspection reference

Written findings or documents received? IDs

Work, repairs and condition changes

Track actual activity or changes after reported work. Record what you observed and who a source identified.

Change / work ID

Feature / area (private)

Observed date(s)

- [ ] I saw activity directly
- [ ] Another person reported it
- [ ] Agency record describes it
- [ ] Work only proposed
- [ ] Completion unconfirmed
- [ ] Follow-up observed

01 Condition sequence

BEFORE - date, condition and photo ID

DURING - what was actually seen, when and photo ID

AFTER - condition, date and photo ID (or not yet observed)

02 Records and remaining questions

Who performed or recorded the work? Include source ID

Acceptance / work order ID if known

What remains unknown about installation, function, inspection or ongoing upkeep?

Who is documented for each role?

Use names only when a dated source identifies them. Several organizations may have different roles for the same location.

> Do not infer who maintains a structure from road classification alone. Keep each pipe, ditch or outlet distinct, with its source ID and date.

01 Evidence-based role tracker

Role to verify	Organization / name on record	Source ID, date and exact basis
Recorded property interest		
Permit applicant / holder		
Builder / performing contractor		
Approved plan designer		
Approving / reviewing office		
Inspector / finding		
Roadway or right-of-way office		
Pipe / inlet / swale / outlet maintainer		

Unverified role or source needed next

Related feature IDs

Original files and handoff log

Use a stable evidence ID. Preserve unchanged originals, and record every copy or transfer separately.

01 Identify and locate the original

Evidence ID

Exact filename or paper document title

Source / acquired from (private)

Received date + time zone

Original stored where? (private protected reference)

SHA-256 hash or hash record ID

02 Copies and transfers

Date + time	From / to (private codes)	File or copy ID + how sent / purpose

03 Original preservation and sharing status

- ☐ Original remains unmodified
- ☐ Metadata treated as private
- ☐ Permission checked before sharing
- ☐ Access is restricted
- ☐ Edited copy has a new ID
- ☐ Original source is still available

Related event, record or photo IDs

Who keeps the original? Private code

Property conditions and expenses

PRIVATE. Record actual effects, earlier conditions and receipts separately from theories about the cause.

Property-effect ID

Area affected (private)

First observed date

01 Describe the condition you observed

Location, dimensions if measured, time, what was wet or damaged, and when it changed.

Related photo / event IDs

Earlier known condition? Source ID or unknown

02 Maintenance, cleanup and repairs

What action was taken? By whom, when, and what written records or photos exist?

03 Expense record

Date / item or effect	Estimate vs. paid + amount	Receipt, invoice or source ID

Other factors or unresolved questions (prior wear, other weather, missing inspection).

Missing records and next steps

Check only what has actually been received. A missing document is an open question until the source responds.

01 Records or findings physically or digitally in hand

- [ ] Approved grading/site plans and dated revisions
- [ ] Relevant original and current surveys with datum
- [ ] Drainage design details and calculations (if applicable)
- [ ] Pipe sizes, inlet / invert / outlet measurements
- [ ] Verified downstream water path and outlet
- [ ] Recorded drainage easements and maintenance agreements
- [ ] Permit conditions, inspection logs and revisions
- [ ] Written asset ownership and maintenance information
- [ ] Environmental authorization / applicability response
- [ ] Documented field visit and written findings

Permit, parcel or feature IDs concerned

Updated date

02 Most important information still needed

1. What is missing, who may have it, and which request / case ID applies?

2. What is missing, who may have it, and which request / case ID applies?

Next action, owner (private code) and follow-up date

Sharing review and permission

This page stays private. Share only a separately prepared, approved summary when appropriate.

Proposed summary ID

Date

Supporting event / record IDs

01 What is supported by firsthand records?

Short, accurate summary, with dates and general locations approved for sharing.

02 What do the obtained documents establish?

Name the issuing source, document date and precise page or record references.

03 What is still unverified?

Outstanding grades, installed drainage, outfall, upkeep or competing explanations.

04 Privacy and accuracy checks

- [ ] No original images or hidden GPS data
- [ ] No unnecessary private contact details
- [ ] No identifiable uninvolved people
- [ ] Every source ID and date checked
- [ ] Uncertainty and alternative factors included
- [ ] Resident approved their own words

Approved to share this specific summary? Yes / No

Reviewer and date (private reference)

Continuation and additional notes

Attach this page to any other form when you need more space. Repeat the related form or event ID.

Related form / event / record ID

Page ___ of ___

Date + time zone

01 Additional firsthand notes or source quotations

Continue without overwriting the original entry. Label direct observations, quotes and inferences.

Additional evidence IDs or original document references

Recorder (private code)

Corrections: add the new date, what changed and why. Keep the earlier entry rather than silently replacing it.